

VASILA MIRSHAMSOVA

<https://github.com/VasilaM>

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

Princeton University, Princeton, NJ, USA

AB in Computer Science, Minor in Statistics and Machine Learning (GPA: 3.8/4.0, magna cum laude)

Courses: DSA, Linear Algebra, Contemporary Logic Design, Probability Theory, Machine Learning, Graphic Design, Advanced Programming Techniques, Distributed Systems, Information Security, Cryptography, Computational Theory, fMRI Analysis

Extracurricular: Central Asian Student Association (President), Princeton Women in CS, Residential College Advisor

Research & Professional Interests: online security & privacy, computational neuroscience (fMRI), consciousness, AI alignment

Key Skills: Python, HTML/CSS/JS, Java, React, C/C++, Go, AI fluency, fMRI data analysis, Russian, Tajik, Korean (elementary)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Incoming Software Engineer (October 2026)

Google (YouTube); San Bruno, California

- Entry-level software engineer at tech giant with over 100 million active daily users

AI Research Intern (June 2026 - present)

Center for Neuroscience Imaging Research at Sungkyunkwan University; Suwon, South Korea

- Extending a research project on neurons correlated with hallucination in LLMs, advised by Dr. Hakwan Lau

Software Engineering Intern (May 2025 - August 2025)

Google (YouTube); San Bruno, California

- Writing, presenting, and constantly iterating upon a 25+ page design document for the end-to-end migration of YouTube Live component from native mobile (Java & Objective-C) code to an internal multi-platform language
- Developing, testing, and launching the migrated mobile Live Chat header interacted with by millions of daily users
- Coding in C++ (server backend), Java (client side), Proto (IDL), and Elements (frontend) and collaborating across four different teams owning various components involved in the migration

Software and Content Development Intern (May 2024 - August 2024)

The Guardian Project; Somerville, Massachusetts (remote)

- Designed and programmed an Android app to demonstrate to developers how to integrate the ability to encrypt traffic with pluggable transports and Arti, a Rust implementation of the Tor network, into their apps
- Engaged in research, design, and development of security and privacy-focused digital apps and open-source projects within a tech nonprofit
- Attended scrums, participated in testing and design sessions, and documented progress and technical insights in blog posts

Head of Web Design and Development (September 2022 - December 2024)

The Daily Princetonian; Princeton, New Jersey

- Collaborating with staff across an organization of nearly 200 students to produce weekly web-based content for the university community and a broader audience of over 30,000 daily online readers
- Leading 20 students in web dev. section with co-editors, delegating tasks and guiding staff with 10-12 projects/semester
- Managing timelines, facilitating weekly meetings and work sessions, fostering fun and friendly team environment
- Ideating, designing, and developing unique web projects using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, JQuery and other need-specific JS libraries for 3-4 articles and special issues per semester; NJ College Newspaper Contest-winning examples include the [Career Issue](#), [12 Hours in Murray Dodge Cafe](#), and [Eating Club Tax Returns](#).

Calculus and CS Tutor (January 2023 - May 2024)

The McGraw Center for Teaching and Learning; Princeton, New Jersey

- Overseeing groups of 10-25 students in study hall sessions, collaborating with fellow tutors to facilitate a supportive, dynamic, student-centered learning environment
 - Guiding students through the quantitative problem-solving process for ~12 hours a week; encouraging critical thinking and sharing technical tips and tricks
 - Established a client base of 7-8 returning students with personalized, responsive, and nurturing approach in 1-on-1 tutoring
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PROJECTS

Funny Story: The Effects of Background Laughter on Humor Processing in the Brain, Senior Thesis

- Performed fMRI data analysis to find that participants listening to a version of a short story with laughter in the background had a significant increase in brain activity in regions associated with humor as opposed to participants who listened to the same story without background noise. Available on [GitHub](#).
- Received Princeton Center for Statistics and Machine Learning 2026 Independent Work Award for Best Work.

Office Hours @ Princeton, Project Manager and Lead Developer (September 2024 - May 2025; Princeton, NJ)

- Ideated, designed and developed <https://officehoursatprinceton.onrender.com/>, a dynamic three-tiered calendar-like web application allowing Princeton students to easily view their office hours in one location; led backend development with Python/Flask, PostgreSQL, FullCalendar (JS library) tech stack; handled Princeton CAS authentication and hosting on Render
- Led a team of five developers and engaged in software development best practices by tracking team workflow, setting up user meetings, and managing responsibilities